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No SF-2026-10-ENSO-IOD

Current condition and forecasts of ENSO and IOD for OND 2026

Issued on 06th October 2026 by Seasonal Forecasting Division of the Department of Meteorology, Sri Lanka.

1. El Nino and La Nina update

El Niño is present. Equatorial sea surface temperatures (SSTs) are above average across the east central and eastern Pacific Ocean. The atmospheric circulation anomalies over the equatorial Pacific Ocean are consistent with El Niño. During October-December through December-January 2026-27, there is a greater than 90% chance of a very strong El Niño (source-CPC-NOAA).

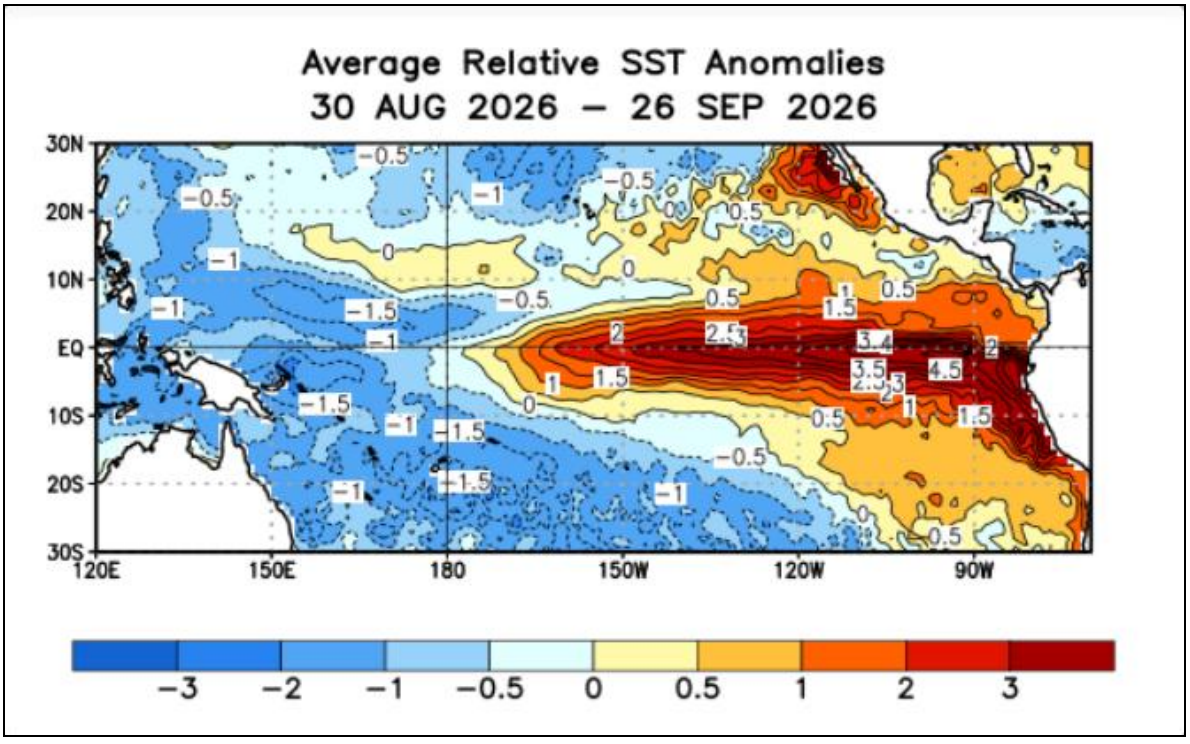


Fig 1: Observed Average Sea surface temperature (SST) anomalies (°C)

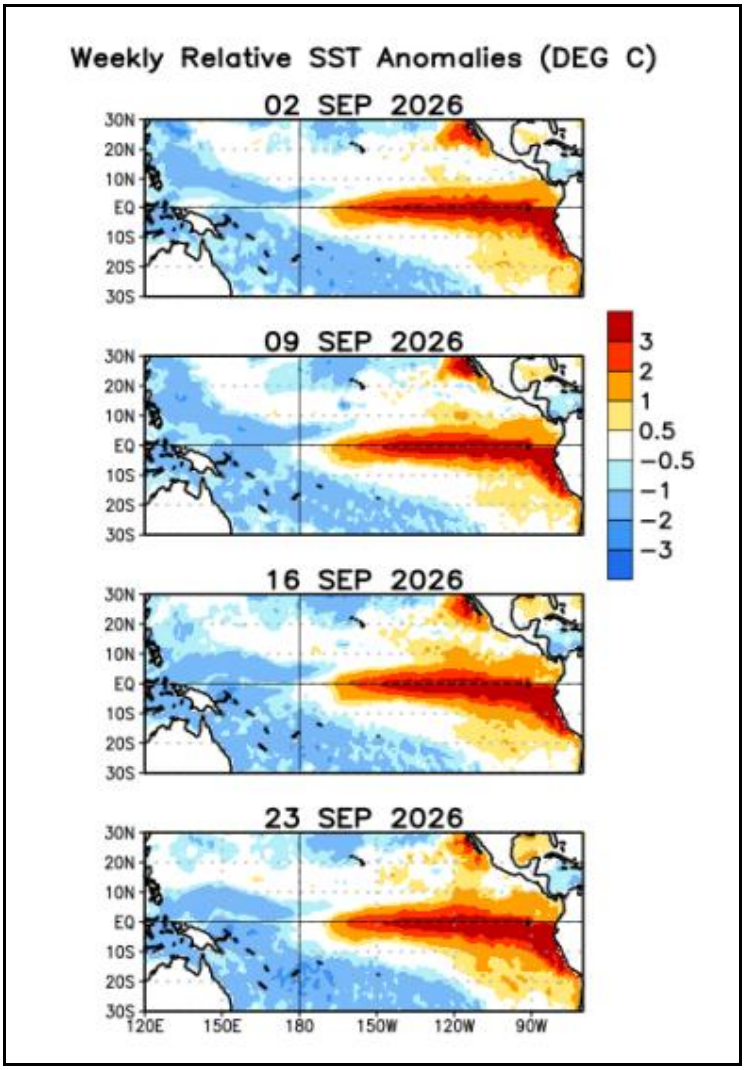


Fig 2: Weekly Observed Average Sea surface temperature (SST) anomalies (°C)

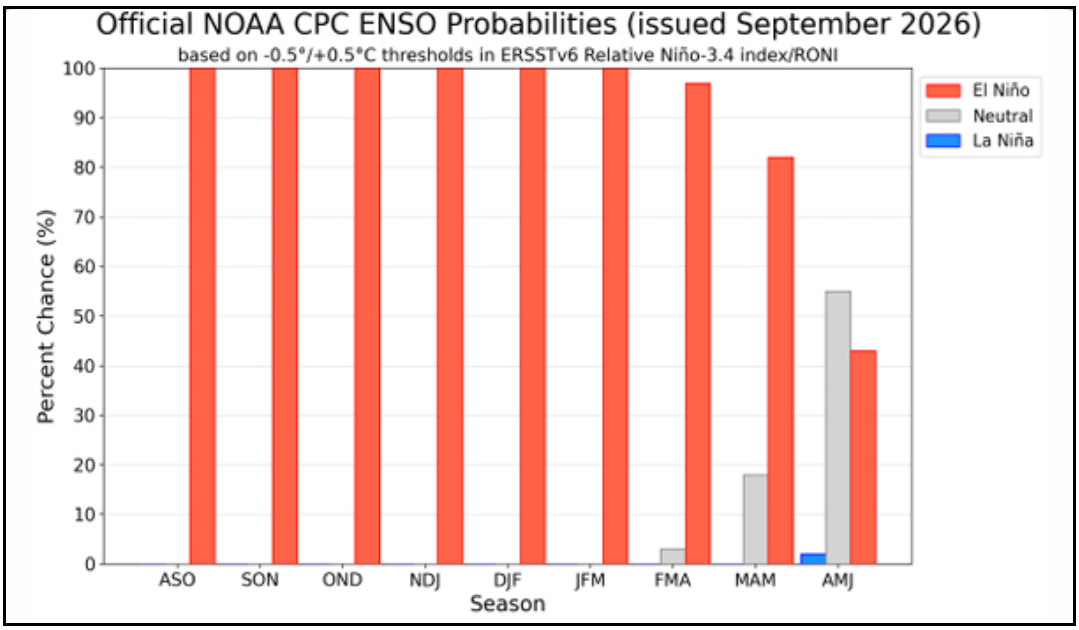


Fig 3a: ENSO forecast from Climate Prediction Center (CPC)/ IRI Forecast

1.1 CPC Probabilistic ENSO Strength Outlook

During September-November through November-January 2026-27, there is a greater than 90% chance of a very strong El Niño. During the October December 2026 season, there is a 75% chance of a historic event that would exceed the strength of previous El Niño events dating back to 1950.

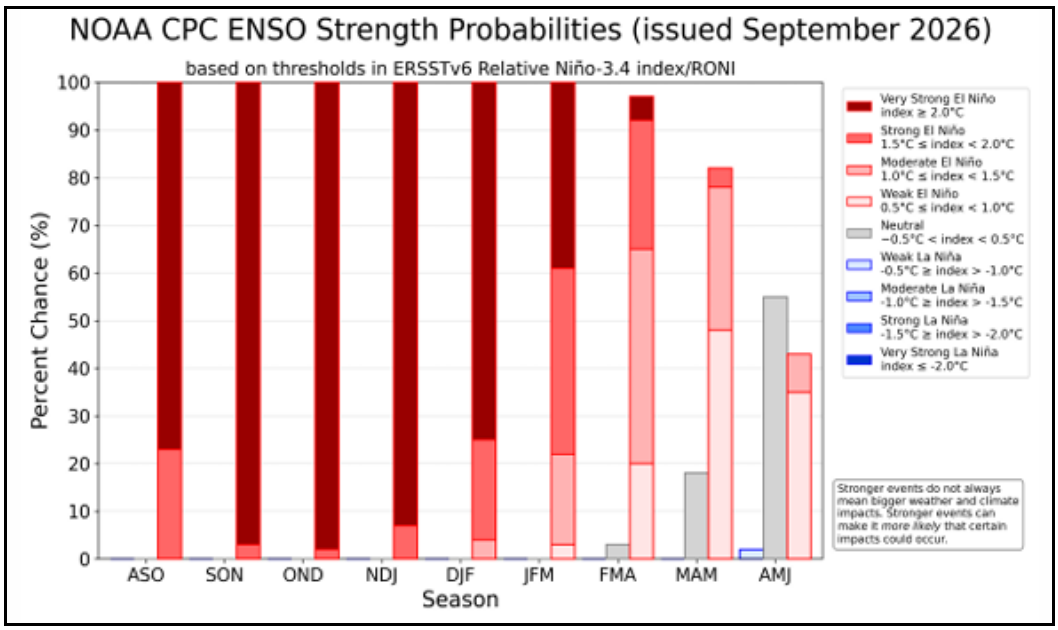


Fig 3b: ENSO strength Probabilities (CPC-NOAA)

1.2 Impacts of El-Nino on monthly rainfall anomaly during October, November and December

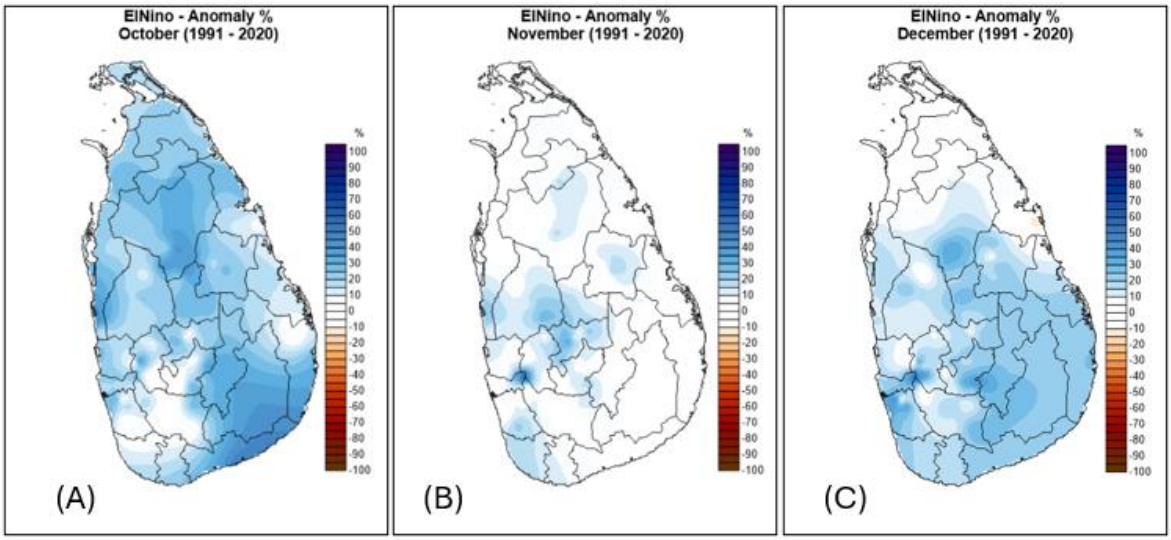


Fig 3c: Monthly Rainfall Anomaly maps of the months of October (A), November (B) and December (C) during El-Nino years (Department of Meteorology-Research Division)

Research conducted by the Department of Meteorology, it has been found that, above normal rainfall was received in most parts of the country and some areas in Rathnapura, Kegalle and Kalutara it was reported near normal rainfall during the month of October. During the month of November near to slightly above normal rainfall was received over most parts of the country. During the month of December near normal rainfall was reported in Northern province and some areas in Trincomalee and

Anuradhapura districts and above normal rainfall was received over remaining parts of the country while the El-Nino conditions were prevailed. (Fig 3c).

2. The Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) update

The Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) is currently neutral although the IOD index value for the week ending 27 September 2026 is +0.76 °C. Models suggest a positive IOD is likely to develop during the southern hemisphere spring, although there is still uncertainty in the strength and duration of the event. (source- BOM, Australia).

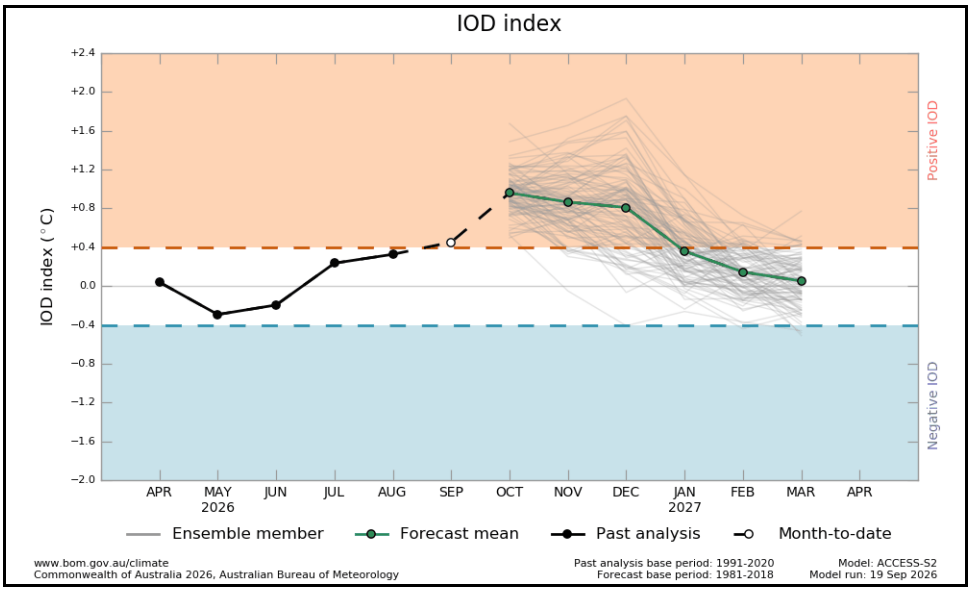


Figure 4a: IOD forecast from Australian Bureau of Meteorology